

NORTHSTAR MUTUAL ? ADVANCED IMAGING POLICY
MRI / CT utilization management

Section 3 ? Clinical documentation

Orders for MRI brain (70553) or lumbar MRI (72148)

must include:

1. Ordering physician clinical notes
2. Symptom duration and red-flag screen
3. Prior imaging comparison when available

Prior authorization is required before elective outpatient advanced imaging is performed.

Timely filing: 120 days.